

HISTORY CLASS 12 TOPIC ANALYSIS

Based on Previous Year Question Papers | BE A TOPPER Series

SECTION 1: ANCIENT INDIA

The Harappan Civilization

- ◆ **Subsistence Strategies:** How they procured food, dietary practices, and agricultural technologies (plough, irrigation).
- ◆ **Urban Planning:** Town planning, drainage systems, and domestic architecture.
- ◆ **Craft Production:** Strategies for procuring raw materials (shell, metal, stone) and centers of production.
- ◆ **Archaeological Discoveries:** The contributions of archaeologists like Alexander Cunningham, John Marshall, and R.E.M. Wheeler.

Early States and Economies (c. 600 BCE – 600 CE)

- ◆ **Magadha & Mauryan Empire:** The rise of Magadha, the shift of the capital from Rajagaha to Pataliputra, and the administration under Ashoka (Dhamma, officials).
- ◆ **Inscriptions & Coins:** The value and limitations of inscriptions in reconstructing history; significance of coinage (Gupta, Yaudheyas, Roman connections).

Social Histories (Mahabharata)

- ◆ **Kinship & Marriage:** Rules of marriage (endogamy, exogamy, polygyny, polyandry), the importance of patriliney, and the gotra system.
- ◆ **Caste & Class:** Social hierarchy and the status of different groups (Brahmanas, Kshatriyas).

Thinkers, Beliefs, and Buildings

- ◆ **Sanchi Stupa:** Its structural features, history, and the role of the Begums of Bhopal in its preservation.
- ◆ **Religious Philosophies:** Basic teachings of Buddhism (Sutta Pitaka) and Jainism (Karma, rebirth).
- ◆ **Puranic Hinduism:** The rise of Vaishnavism and Shaivism and temple architecture.

SECTION 2: MEDIEVAL INDIA

Through the Eyes of Travellers

- ◆ **Key Travellers:** Al-Biruni (observations on caste), Ibn Battuta (observations on cities, coconut, paan), and Francois Bernier (critique of land ownership).

Bhakti-Sufi Traditions

- ◆ **Saints & Devotion:** The teachings of Kabir Das (Nirguna Bhakti), Guru Nanak Dev Ji, and Mirabai.
- ◆ **Sufism:** The Chisti silsila (Shaikh Muinuddin Chishti), importance of Dargah, and relationship with state.
- ◆ **Virashaiva Tradition:** Basavanna and the movement in Karnataka.

An Imperial Capital: Vijayanagara

- ◆ **Architecture:** The Sacred Centre versus the Royal Centre (Mahanavami Dibba, Lotus Mahal, temples).
- ◆ **Fortification:** Massive walls and water management systems (Hiriya Canal).
- ◆ **Dynasties:** Rise and decline of the empire and the Battle of Talikota.

The Mughal Empire

- ◆ **Ain-i-Akbari:** Significance as a source for administration and agrarian history.
- ◆ **Mughal Court:** Akbar's Darbar, chronicles, and the role of women in the household.
- ◆ **Agrarian Relations:** The role of Zamindars and the village Panchayat.

SECTION 3: MODERN INDIA

Colonialism and the Countryside

- ◆ **Bengal:** The Permanent Settlement, power struggle between Zamindars and Jotedars, and the Fifth Report.
- ◆ **Rajmahal Hills:** Conflict between the Paharias (hoe) and the Santhals (plough).
- ◆ **Bombay Deccan:** The Ryotwari system, cotton boom effects, and Deccan Riots.

Rebels and the Raj (1857 Revolt)

- ◆ **Causes:** Subsidiary Alliance, annexation of Awadh, and religious grievances.
- ◆ **Leaders:** Kunwar Singh, Rani Laxmibai, Nana Saheb, and Bahadur Shah Zafar.
- ◆ **Suppression:** British military power and laws passed to suppress the revolt.

Mahatma Gandhi & Nationalist Movement

- ◆ **Key Movements:** Non-Cooperation Movement, Salt Satyagraha (Dandi March), and Quit India Movement.
- ◆ **Gandhi's Persona:** Role as social reformer vs political leader and sources to reconstruct his life.

Framing the Constitution

- ◆ **Key Debates:** Federalism, Objectives Resolution (Nehru), and the language controversy.
- ◆ **Personalities:** Roles of B.R. Ambedkar, Jawaharlal Nehru, and B.N. Rau.

IMPORTANT MAP TOPICS

◆ **Harappan Sites:** Lothal, Banawali, Dholavira, Kalibangan.

◆ **Buddhist Sites:** Bodh Gaya, Sanchi, Bharhut, Amravati.

◆ **Centres of 1857:** Delhi, Meerut, Jhansi, Gwalior, Lucknow, Kanpur, Arrah.

◆ **National Movement:** Champaran, Kheda, Ahmedabad, Amritsar, Chauri Chaura, Dandi.

◆ **Medieval Cities:** Vijayanagara (Hampi), Agra, Delhi, Goa.

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